

Invoice Fraud Tabletop

Payment Under Pressure

A 60-minute supplier invoice diversion tabletop

Rehearse the decisions a small organisation faces when a supplier payment change may be fraudulent. Bring finance, IT and leadership together, record what you know, and leave with owned follow-up actions.

For a small finance team, an IT contact and a decision maker. Allow about 15 minutes for a facilitator to prepare. No access to production systems is required.

What the team will practise

- Identify who can pause a disputed supplier payment and how the hold would be confirmed.
- Choose a verification route whose trust does not depend on the suspicious message.
- Coordinate finance and IT when payment status and email integrity are uncertain.
- Capture evidence, decisions, ownership and unresolved questions without overstating the facts.
- Agree conditions for resuming payments and assign improvements with evidence of completion.

Bring to the session

- Bring your current payment approval and incident escalation procedures if they exist.
- Nominate someone who can describe how your organisation actually approves supplier bank-detail changes.
- Use fictional or redacted details in the session records. No credentials, account balances or customer data are needed.

Practice scope

- This exercise explores decision making; it does not test technical controls or demonstrate that an account is secure.
- If no response procedure exists, record that gap. An improvised tabletop decision is not an approved production procedure.
- The material does not determine reporting duties, insurance coverage or legal liability. Assign those questions to the appropriate adviser during a real incident.

All scenario details are fictional. The kit includes no live facilitation, incident-response service, technical control test or guarantee of recovery. The guide ends with five printable worksheet templates and official references.

The changed payment details

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FICTIONAL EXERCISE - NO REAL ACTIONS

Finance receives a message in an existing Kestrel Components invoice thread: 'Please use our replacement account for today's CHF18,600 payment. The old account is being closed. Confirm when released so we can allocate the shipment.' The invoice number and amount match a genuine purchase. The proposed destination is SIMULATED ACCOUNT B; the supplier record currently contains SIMULATED ACCOUNT A. The routine payment run is approaching. No independent verification has been completed.

Discuss together

- What do we know, and which parts of the request remain unverified?
- Who can pause this item, and what evidence would confirm the pause has taken effect?
- How would we verify the supplier's request without relying on contact details in this message?
- Who owns the decision while the usual approver is unavailable?

Decision _____

Owner _____

Evidence needed _____

Next checkpoint _____